APOD-TR-004-ANNEX-X

Policy & Dataset Lineage

(Informative — Non-Normative Companion Annex)

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**Status and Intent**

This annex is provided for interpretive clarity, traceability, and audit support only. It is **informative**, not normative.

This annex:

- does **not** grant policy authority or define policy ratification processes;
- does **not** certify, validate, or approve datasets;
- does **not** modify Compliance Star Certificate (CSC) semantics, scoring logic, or thresholds;
- does **not** assert readiness, approval, alignment, or trust; and
- does **not** substitute for regulatory or legal determination.

**Authority Boundary**

Governance authority, assurance semantics, and trust interpretation remain defined exclusively by **Volume 2 — Version A** and applicable external regulatory or standards frameworks. Nothing in this annex alters, constrains, or supersedes that authority.

**Use Constraint**

Lineage documentation supports declaration and interpretation under containment. Lineage records shall **not** be used as evidence of compliance or trust and shall **not** be marketed as certification.

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**1. Purpose and Positioning**

This annex defines a lineage and traceability model for policy evolution and dataset status across the AI system lifecycle. It is intended to support interpretability, auditability, and governance continuity, **not** to establish approval authority or certification criteria.

**2. Scope Boundaries**

This annex applies to:

- documentation and traceability of policy change over time; and
- documentation and traceability of dataset status over time.

It does **not**:

- define how policies are legally ratified;
- define dataset validation thresholds;
- override sector-specific regulatory requirements; or
- imply readiness, approval, or trust.

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**Part I — Policy Lineage**

**3. Policy Lineage Objectives**

- Enable clear historical traceability of policy evolution.
- Prevent policy ambiguity during system operation and audit.
- Support runtime governance interpretation when multiple policy states coexist.

**4. Policy State Categories (Descriptive, Not Prescriptive)**

This annex recognizes that policies may exist simultaneously in different states:

**Legacy Policy**
Previously established policies still in force or partially applicable.

**Proposed Policy**
Draft, consultative, or exploratory policy instruments not yet authoritative.

**Amended Policy**
Updated or revised policy instruments that supersede or modify earlier versions.

These categories are **descriptive markers**, not hierarchy or precedence rules.

**5. Policy Lineage Metadata (Recommended Fields)**

For traceability and governance interpretation, policy artifacts may include:

- policy identifier and version;
- status label (legacy / proposed / amended);
- effective date and review date;

- jurisdiction or sector scope;
- supersedes / superseded-by references; and
- declared applicability constraints.

This metadata supports **audit clarity**, not enforcement authority.

**6. Policy Lineage and Runtime Governance**

- Runtime governance mechanisms operate under a **declared policy context**.
- Policy lineage informs **interpretation**, not execution authority.
- Where policy ambiguity exists, systems shall default to **constrained operation** under containment principles.

**7. Policy Lineage and Assurance Interpretation**

- Policy lineage does **not** alter CSC scoring logic.
- Assurance signals must be interpreted within the **declared policy context**.
- No policy state alone constitutes evidence of compliance or trust.

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**Part II — Dataset Lineage**

**8. Dataset Lineage Objectives**

- Enable clear visibility into dataset origin, status, and evolution.
- Prevent dataset inclusion from being misinterpreted as validation or approval.
- Support governance decisions during onboarding, operation, and reassessment.

**9. Dataset Status Categories (Informative)**

This annex recognizes common dataset states encountered in practice:

**Operational Dataset**
Actively used datasets with established provenance.

**Proposed / Experimental Dataset**
Datasets under testing, evaluation, or limited exposure.

**Verified Dataset (External Authority)**
Datasets that have been validated or approved under an external governance or regulatory regime.

These categories describe **status**, not trust level.

### 10. Dataset Lineage Metadata (Recommended Fields)

For traceability and governance clarity, dataset artifacts may include:

- dataset identifier and version;
- status declaration;
- source and provenance summary;
- scope of permitted use;
- testing or evaluation notes; and
- external verification references (if applicable).

Dataset metadata supports **interpretability**, not certification.

### 11. Dataset Lineage and Runtime Governance

- Dataset status informs **containment posture**, not assurance level.
- Experimental or provisional datasets trigger **constrained operation**.
- Dataset changes are treated as **governance-relevant lifecycle events**.

### 12. Dataset Lineage and Assurance Interpretation

- Dataset inclusion alone shall **not** elevate CSC posture.
- CSC scoring remains derived exclusively from **telemetry and observed behavior**.
- Dataset lineage supports audit review and reassessment, **not trust inference**.

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## Part III — Cross-Cutting Considerations

### 13. Policy and Dataset Co-Evolution

- Policies and datasets evolve on different timelines.
- Governance must accommodate **asynchronous change**.
- Lineage documentation prevents false assumptions during transition periods.

### 14. Relationship to System Maturity

- Early-stage systems will exhibit **higher lineage uncertainty**.
- Mature systems should demonstrate **stable lineage documentation**.
- Lineage clarity strengthens, but does **not** replace, containment and evidence.

### 15. Relationship to Versions A, B, and C

- **Version A** defines governance authority and assurance semantics.

- **Version B** may illustrate lineage handling at execution depth.
- **Version C** explicitly excludes lineage definition and relies only on declaration and containment.

This annex exists **outside Version C** to preserve onboarding discipline.

**16. Non-Claims and Safeguards**

This annex shall not be used to:

- assert compliance;
- imply approval;
- market trust;
- substitute for regulatory determination; or
- bypass evidence-based assurance.

Lineage documentation enhances clarity; it does **not** confer authority.

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**Closing Note**

Policy and dataset lineage are **interpretive tools**, not governance outcomes. They support transparency, auditability, and responsible evolution of AI systems, while leaving trust determination where it belongs: in **continuous, evidence-based governance**.